

Table 4. Evidentiary hierarchy for contemporaneous activation

Channel / design	Focal estimate	Inference	Interpretation
Persistent-average CPU pricing	All six CPU × architecture slopes small	Raw p = 0.428-0.816	No universal same-month architecture premium
Persistent-average continuous activation	All six CPU × VIX × architecture slopes null	Raw p = 0.191-0.914	Persistence alone does not ensure activation
External financing, snapshot design	-0.00654	Date-clustered p = 0.0044; permutation p = 0.0001	Primary contemporaneous mechanism
Growth-duration, joint stress	-0.01287	Clustered p = 0.0588; permutation p = 0.0001	Threshold channel; partly factor mediated
Concentration, continuous activation	-0.00340	p = 0.0337; HML p = 0.0192; directed permutation p = 0.0001	Supporting amplification evidence
Internal capacity	Expected protective sign not supported	Impact estimates null or contrary-signed	Counter-result

Note. Snapshot estimates use the 2025Q4 architecture cross-section and the broader robustness pipeline. Persistent-average models use the mean of 2023Q4-2025Q4 scores.